

Clean Portfolio Design System Guidelines 2024-2025

1. Brand Identity & Philosophy

Core Principles

- **Premium Quality:** Every design element should convey professionalism and attention to detail
 - **Human-Centered:** Focus on user experience and emotional connection
 - **Consistent:** Maintain visual harmony across all components and touchpoints
 - **Adaptive:** Flexible system that works across various formats and platforms
 - **Performance-Driven:** Optimized for speed and accessibility
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2. Color Palette

The Professional Five

Our entire design system is built around these five carefully selected colors:

Primary Colors

CSS

/ Deep Black – Primary Headlines & CTAs */*

bg-slate-950 */* #020617 */*

text-slate-950 */* #020617 */*

/ Professional Blue – Brand & Interactive Elements */*

bg-blue-600 */* #2563eb */*

text-blue-600 */* #2563eb */*

/ Success Green – Positive Actions & Status */*

bg-emerald-500 */* #10b981 */*

text-emerald-500 */* #10b981 */*

Neutral Colors

CSS

```
/* Cool Gray – Body Text & Secondary Elements */
bg-slate-500    /* #64748b */
text-slate-500  /* #64748b */

/* Light Background – Sections & Cards */
bg-slate-100    /* #f1f5f9 */
text-slate-100  /* #f1f5f9 */

/* Pure White – Clean Containers */
bg-white        /* #ffffff */
text-white      /* #ffffff */
```

Color Usage Rules

60-30-10 Rule Implementation:

- **60%:** White and light backgrounds ((bg-white), (bg-slate-100))
- **30%:** Deep black for structure and text ((text-slate-950))
- **10%:** Blue and green for accents ((bg-blue-600), (bg-emerald-500))

3. Typography System

Font Family

CSS

```
font-family: 'Inter', 'SF Pro Display', -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, sans-serif;
```

Typography Hierarchy

Headings

CSS

```
/* Hero/Display Titles */  
.heading-hero: text-4xl md:text-6xl lg:text-7xl font-bold text-slate-950;  
  
/* Large Headlines */  
.heading-xl: text-3xl md:text-5xl lg:text-6xl font-bold text-slate-950;  
  
/* Section Headers */  
.heading-lg: text-2xl md:text-3xl font-bold text-slate-950;  
  
/* Component Titles */  
.heading-md: text-xl md:text-2xl font-bold text-slate-950;  
  
/* Card Titles */  
.heading-sm: text-lg font-bold text-slate-950;  
  
/* Subtitle Text */  
.heading-xs: text-base font-bold text-slate-950;
```

Body Text

CSS

```
/* Large Body Text */  
.text-large: text-lg md:text-xl leading-relaxed font-normal text-slate-500;  
  
/* Standard Body Text */  
.text-standard: text-base leading-relaxed font-normal text-slate-500;  
  
/* Small Text */  
.text-small: text-sm font-normal text-slate-500;  
  
/* Caption Text */  
.text-caption: text-xs font-medium text-slate-500;
```

Font Weights

CSS

```
font-bold      /* Headings, CTAs */  
font-semibold /* Subheadings, emphasis */  
font-medium   /* Navigation, labels */  
font-normal   /* Body text */  
font-light    /* Body paragraphs */
```

Text Casing Guidelines

When to Use Each Case:

- **UPPERCASE:** Brand taglines, category labels, navigation badges
 - **Title Case:** Main headlines, hero titles, product names, button text, card titles
 - **Sentence case:** Body text, descriptions, form labels, captions, metadata
 - **capitalize (CSS):** Dynamic content requiring consistent title casing
-

4. Spacing & Layout System

Core Principle

All layouts follow proportional spacing to maintain consistent rhythm and visual hierarchy.

Section Spacing

```
css

/* Large sections */
py-24 px-8

/* Medium sections */
py-16 px-8

/* Small sections */
py-12 px-8

/* Container max-widths */
max-w-6xl mx-auto /* Standard container */
max-w-7xl mx-auto /* Wide container */
max-w-4xl mx-auto /* Narrow container */
```

Component Spacing

CSS

```
/* Between elements */
space-y-8 /* Large gaps */
space-y-6 /* Medium gaps */
space-y-4 /* Small gaps */
space-y-2 /* Tiny gaps */
```

```
/* Internal padding */
p-8 /* Large cards */
p-6 /* Medium cards */
p-4 /* Small cards */
p-3 /* Buttons */
```

Grid Systems

CSS

```
/* Responsive grids */
grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3 gap-8
grid grid-cols-1 lg:grid-cols-2 gap-12
grid md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-4 gap-8
```

```
/* Flex layouts */
flex flex-col sm:flex-row gap-4
flex items-center justify-between
flex flex-wrap gap-4
```

5. Component Patterns

Cards

CSS

```
/* Standard Card */
bg-white p-8 rounded-2xl shadow-lg border border-slate-200
```

```
/* Elevated Card */
bg-white p-8 rounded-2xl shadow-xl border border-slate-100
```

```
/* Dark Card */
bg-slate-950 p-8 rounded-2xl shadow-xl border border-slate-800
```

```
/* Hover Effects */
hover:shadow-2xl hover:-translate-y-2 transition-all duration-300
```

Buttons

Primary Button

css

```
bg-blue-600 text-white px-8 py-4 rounded-full font-bold  
hover:bg-blue-700 hover:-translate-y-1 hover:shadow-xl  
transition-all duration-300
```

Secondary Button

css

```
bg-white text-slate-950 border-2 border-slate-200 px-8 py-4 rounded-full font-bold  
hover:border-blue-600 hover:text-blue-600 hover:bg-slate-50  
transition-all duration-300
```

Success Button

css

```
bg-emerald-500 text-white px-8 py-4 rounded-full font-bold  
hover:bg-emerald-600 hover:-translate-y-1 hover:shadow-xl  
transition-all duration-300
```

Ghost Button

css

```
bg-transparent border-2 border-slate-500 text-slate-950 px-8 py-4 rounded-full font-bo  
hover:bg-slate-950 hover:text-white hover:border-slate-950  
transition-all duration-300
```

Badges/Tags

CSS

```
/* Status Badge - Available */
bg-emerald-100 text-emerald-800 border border-emerald-200 px-4 py-2 rounded-full text-sm font-medium

/* Tech Stack Tag */
bg-slate-100 text-slate-700 px-3 py-1 rounded-full text-sm font-medium
hover:bg-slate-200 transition-colors duration-200

/* Service Category */
bg-blue-100 text-blue-800 px-4 py-2 rounded-full text-sm font-semibold

/* Featured Badge */
bg-slate-950 text-white px-4 py-2 rounded-full text-sm font-bold
```

6. Animation Patterns

CSS Animations

CSS

```
/* Pulse effect */
animate-pulse

/* Bounce effect */
animate-bounce

/* Custom transitions */
transition-all duration-300
transition-colors duration-200
transition-transform duration-300
```

Framer Motion Variants

javascript

// Fade in from bottom

```
const fadeInUp = {  
  initial: { opacity: 0, y: 60 },  
  animate: { opacity: 1, y: 0 },  
  transition: { duration: 0.8, ease: "easeOut" }  
};
```

// Slide in from left

```
const slideInLeft = {  
  initial: { opacity: 0, x: -50 },  
  animate: { opacity: 1, x: 0 },  
  transition: { duration: 0.6 }  
};
```

// Stagger children

```
const staggerContainer = {  
  animate: {  
    transition: {  
      staggerChildren: 0.1  
    }  
  }  
};
```

// Scale on hover

```
whileHover={{ scale: 1.05, y: -2 }}  
whileTap={{ scale: 0.95 }}
```

Animation Timing Guidelines

- **Entrance animations:** 0.6-0.8s duration
 - **Hover effects:** 0.2-0.3s duration
 - **Stagger delay:** 0.1-0.2s between elements
 - **Page transitions:** 0.5s duration
-

7. Background Patterns

Solid Backgrounds

CSS

```
/* Hero sections */
```

```
bg-slate-950
```

```
/* Light sections */
```

```
bg-slate-100
```

```
/* Dark sections */
```

```
bg-slate-950
```

```
/* Card backgrounds */
```

```
bg-white
```

```
/* Accent sections */
```

```
bg-blue-600
```

Subtle Effects

CSS

```
/* Clean glass effect without gradients */
```

```
bg-white/90 backdrop-blur-sm border border-white/50
```

```
/* Dark glass */
```

```
bg-slate-950/90 backdrop-blur-sm border border-slate-800/50
```

```
/* Floating decorative elements */
```

```
absolute top-1/4 left-1/4 w-96 h-96 bg-blue-600/5 rounded-full blur-3xl
```

8. Responsive Design

Breakpoint Strategy

CSS

```
/* Mobile First Approach */
```

```
/* Base: 0-639px */
```

```
sm: /* 640px+ */
```

```
md: /* 768px+ */
```

```
lg: /* 1024px+ */
```

```
xl: /* 1280px+ */
```

```
2xl: /* 1536px+ */
```

Common Responsive Patterns

CSS

```
/* Text scaling */  
text-4xl md:text-6xl lg:text-7xl  
  
/* Grid responsive */  
grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3  
  
/* Padding responsive */  
px-4 md:px-8 lg:px-12  
  
/* Flex responsive */  
flex-col sm:flex-row  
  
/* Visibility responsive */  
hidden lg:block  
block lg:hidden
```

9. Interactive States

Hover Effects

CSS

```
/* Scale up */  
hover:scale-105  
  
/* Shadow enhancement */  
hover:shadow-2xl  
  
/* Color changes */  
hover:text-blue-600  
hover:bg-slate-100  
  
/* Transform */  
hover:-translate-y-2
```

Focus States

CSS

```
focus:outline-none focus:ring-4 focus:ring-blue-600/20 focus:border-blue-600
```

Active States

CSS

```
active:scale-95  
active:bg-blue-700
```

10. Icon Guidelines

Icon Sizes

CSS

```
w-4 h-4  /* Small icons */  
w-5 h-5  /* Medium icons */  
w-6 h-6  /* Large icons */  
w-8 h-8  /* Extra large icons */
```

Icon Colors

CSS

```
text-slate-500  /* Muted icons */  
text-white      /* Light icons */  
text-blue-600   /* Accent icons */  
text-slate-950  /* Primary icons */  
currentColor    /* Inherit parent color */
```

11. Compact Design Guidelines

Philosophy of Compact Design

Modern users expect efficient, scannable interfaces that deliver maximum value in minimal space. Components should be compact yet comprehensive, efficient yet elegant.

Compact Spacing Guidelines

CSS

```
/* Compact Section Spacing */  
py-12 md:py-16 /* Instead of py-16 md:py-24 */  
  
/* Compact Component Spacing */  
p-6 md:p-8 /* Instead of p-8 md:p-12 */  
  
/* Compact Card Spacing */  
p-4 md:p-6 /* Instead of p-6 md:p-8 */  
  
/* Compact Gap Spacing */  
gap-4 md:gap-6 /* Instead of gap-6 md:gap-8 */
```

Compact Typography Scale

CSS

```
/* Reduced but Still Impactful */  
.compact-hero: text-3xl md:text-4xl lg:text-5xl;  
.compact-heading: text-2xl md:text-3xl;  
.compact-subheading: text-lg md:text-xl;  
.compact-body: text-sm md:text-base;
```

When to Use Compact Design

Use Compact Design For:

- CTA sections above footers
- Contact forms and inquiry sections
- Service selection components
- Mobile-first responsive layouts
- Secondary pages with focused purposes

Use Standard Design For:

- Hero sections and landing page headers
- Detailed service descriptions
- About us and company information
- Product showcases and portfolios
- Main navigation and primary content

12. Content Guidelines

Section Structure

1. Header with badge (optional)
2. Main heading (large, bold)
3. Subtitle/description (medium, muted)
4. Content/grid
5. Call-to-action (if applicable)

Card Structure

1. Icon/visual element
 2. Title (bold)
 3. Description (muted)
 4. Tags/badges (if applicable)
 5. Action button/link (if applicable)
-

13. Accessibility Guidelines

Color Contrast

- Ensure minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio for text
- Use multiple visual cues (not just color)
- Test with color blindness simulators

Interactive Elements

- Minimum 44px touch target size
- Clear focus indicators
- Semantic HTML elements
- ARIA labels where needed

Typography

- Readable font sizes (minimum 16px)
 - Sufficient line height (1.5-1.6)
 - Reasonable line length (45-75 characters)
-

14. Performance Guidelines

Animation Performance

- Use transform and opacity for animations
- Avoid animating width, height, top, left
- Use will-change sparingly
- Prefer CSS transforms over JavaScript

Image Optimization

- Use WebP format when possible
- Implement lazy loading
- Provide appropriate alt text
- Use responsive images

15. Component States

Loading States

CSS

```
<div className="animate-pulse bg-slate-200 rounded-lg h-32"></div>
```

Active States

CSS

```
className={` ${isActive  
  ? 'bg-blue-600 text-white shadow-xl scale-105'  
  : 'bg-white text-slate-950 hover:shadow-md'  
} transition-all duration-300`}
```

Error States

CSS

```
<div className="border-2 border-red-200 bg-red-50 text-red-600 p-4 rounded-lg">  
  <p className="font-medium">Error message here</p>  
</div>
```

16. Example Component Template

```

jsx

import React from 'react';

const ComponentName = ({ compact = false }) => {
  const sectionClasses = compact
    ? "py-12 md:py-16 px-8 bg-slate-100"
    : "py-24 px-8 bg-slate-100";

  const containerClasses = compact ? "max-w-4xl mx-auto" : "max-w-6xl mx-auto";

  const headingClasses = compact
    ? "text-2xl md:text-3xl font-bold mb-4 text-slate-950"
    : "text-3xl md:text-5xl font-bold mb-6 text-slate-950";

  return (
    <section className={sectionClasses}>
      <div className={containerClasses}>
        /* Header */
        <div className="text-center mb-16">
          <h2 className={headingClasses}>
            Section Title
          </h2>
          <p className="text-xl text-slate-500 max-w-3xl mx-auto leading-relaxed">
            Section description
          </p>
        </div>

        /* Content */
        <div className={compact ? "grid md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3 gap-4" : "grid m
          /* Component content */
        </div>
      </div>
    </section>
  );
};

export default ComponentName;

```

17. Component Checklist

When creating new components, ensure:

Design Consistency

- Responsive design across all breakpoints

- Consistent spacing using design system values
- Proper color usage from defined palette
- Strategic text casing for readability

✔ **User Experience**

- Smooth animations with appropriate timing
- Accessibility compliance
- Hover/focus states for interactive elements
- Touch-friendly design (44px minimum targets)

✔ **Performance**

- Loading states if applicable
- Error states if applicable
- Clean, semantic HTML
- Performance optimization

✔ **Content Strategy**

- Clear visual separation between sections
- Proper information hierarchy
- Essential information prioritized
- Scannable content structure

18. Compact vs Standard Comparison

Aspect	Standard	Compact
Section Padding	py-16 md:py-24	py-12 md:py-16
Card Padding	p-8 md:p-12	p-4 md:p-6
Grid Gaps	gap-6 md:gap-8	gap-4 md:gap-6
Hero Text	text-5xl md:text-6xl	text-3xl md:text-4xl
Content Layout	Multiple sections	Single main card
Background Effects	Solid colors only	Subtle accent elements
Information Density	Comprehensive	Essential only

This comprehensive design system ensures consistency, accessibility, and professional quality across all components while providing flexibility for both standard and compact layouts based on content needs and user context. The elimination of gradients creates a cleaner, more timeless aesthetic that focuses attention on content and functionality.

